

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 6: Patient Care **POLICY: 6.062**

SUBJECT: Epinephrine Outside the Secure Perimeter

POINT PERSON: Chief of Medicine

APPROVED: Dr. Sara Walker  **DATE: APRIL 23, 2024**
Interim Superintendent

SELECT ONE: ☐ New policy ☒ Minor/technical revision of existing policy
☐ Reaffirmation of existing policy ☐ Major revision of existing policy

PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

- A. Purpose Statement: Oregon State Hospital is committed to safely providing epinephrine auto-injector pens (epinephrine) for emergent situations to a patient who has a known hymenoptera venom allergy (e.g., bee or wasp venom) or another serious allergy with the potential to cause anaphylaxis. Epinephrine for a patient may only be dispensed, carried, and used as directed by this policy for situations while they are outside the secure perimeter.
- B. This policy applies to staff to staff and patients

POLICY

- A. Whenever a Staff, or patient agrees to carry and administer epinephrine when needed outside the secure perimeter, the person accepts full responsibility for carrying and administering it in accordance with the provisions of this policy.
- B. A patient may not carry or administer epinephrine to another patient.
- C. Epinephrine may only be dispensed to a staff or patient if:
 - 1. The physician/nurse practitioner (NP) has assessed the situation and, if approved,
 - 2. Has written an order approving the staff or patient to carry and administer epinephrine when needed.
- D. Before a staff may carry and administer epinephrine while outside the secure perimeter, they must successfully pass the required competency requirements. Only licensed nursing staff, physicians, or NPs may administer epinephrine while outside of the secure perimeter.

1. Staff listed in Attachment A must complete applicable epinephrine medication administration competency on hire.
- E. Before a patient may carry and administer epinephrine while outside the secure perimeter, they must be assessed to be capable of safely administering epinephrine. Such education must be documented.
1. A registered nurse (RN) must educate the patient who is allowed to carry or administer epinephrine before giving epinephrine to them.
 - a. The RN must re-assess their capability to administer epinephrine before giving epinephrine to them for subsequent passes or outings. If needed, the RN must provide additional education and deem they are capable of safely administering epinephrine.
 - b. At each reassessment, per Nursing Services protocol the RN must document whether the person is capable of safely administering epinephrine and whether education was needed or provided.
 2. The RN must educate the patient as follows:
 - a. Initially and at least annually thereafter, the RN must educate the patient in epinephrine self-administration.
 - b. In addition, six months after each training the RN must re-assess whether the patient is capable of safely administering epinephrine and provide education if needed.
 - c. The RN must document all education results on the appropriate medical record form.
- F. At minimum, patient education about epinephrine must include:
1. Medication name, type, and reason for use;
 2. how to administer medication, including process, time, frequency, route, and dose;
 3. Anticipated actions and potential side effects of the medication administered;
 4. Monitoring the effects of the medication;
 5. Other special instructions, including instructions that if epinephrine has been administered to a patient, the person must call 911, notify the patient's unit RN, and call OSH reception; and
 6. Demonstration that the staff or patient is capable of safely administering epinephrine.
- G. If the RN does not believe the patient is able to carry or administer epinephrine and a licensed nurse or medical staff is not available to accompany the patient, the RN may cancel the outing.
- H. An epinephrine pen must be secured at all times.

1. The medication must be dispensed to the automated dispensing cabinet (ADC) according to Pharmacy processes.
 2. Staff may not retrieve epinephrine from an emergency kit or the ADC's emergency supply to send with a patient on an outing or pass.
 3. The staff or patient allowed by this policy to carry or administer epinephrine must keep it on their person at all times in its sealed security bag until needed for the patient or until returned to the ADC.
- I. If epinephrine is administered the staff or patient must report the administration to the RN.
- J. Oregon State Hospital (OSH) follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.
- K. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

PROCEDURES

Procedures A Epinephrine Screening, Education and Use

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment A Epinephrine Training List

RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

OSH Policy 9.002 Training for Staff

REFERENCES

42 Code of Federal Regulations § 482.23(c)(6).

42 Code of Federal Regulations § 482.25.

Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2019). The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for behavioral healthcare, MM 06.01.03. EPs 1-7. Oakbrook Terrace, IL: Author.

Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2019). *The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for hospitals*, MM 06.01.03. EPs 1-7. Oakbrook Terrace, IL: Author.

Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2019). *The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for hospitals*, MM 06.01.01. Oakbrook Terrace, IL: Author.

Oregon Administrative Rule § 309-035-0215.

Oregon Administrative Rule §§ 851-048-0010 – 851-048-0060.

Oregon Revised Statute § 678.036.

Subject: Epinephrine Outside the Secure Perimeter

Policy Number: 6.062

Date: April 23, 2024

PAGE 4 OF 4

Oregon Revised Statute § 678.150.